

# LINDA MORRELL

FORENSIC DOCUMENT EXAMINER | INDEPENDENT EXPERT WITNESS

Morrell Forensic Document Examination • PO Box 12456, Wellington 6140, New Zealand • T +64 21 645 8927 • E lindamorrell@signatureforensic.com.au • W www.signatureforensic.com.au

## EXPERT REPORT

Examination of the Questioned Signature of Gordon Robert Green on an Agreement dated 14 February 2004

Re: The Estate of the late Gordon Robert Green - proposed proceedings concerning a disputed agreement dated 14 February 2004

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Prepared for         | Sherrida L Mackay (directly instructed private client)<br>3 Dundee St, Cambridge Park NSW 2747                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Report examiner      | Linda Morrell<br>Forensic Document Examiner<br>Morrell Forensic Document Examination, Wellington, New Zealand                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Relevant proceeding  | Proposed proceedings concerning the estate of the late Gordon Robert Green.<br>No proceeding had commenced as at the date of issue. This report was prepared regarding proposed proceedings and for preliminary advice. Jurisdiction: Queensland (principal estate asset situate at Lot 18 Lysaght Road, Cambooya QLD). |
| Date of issue        | 2 June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Report version       | 1.0                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Examiner's reference | LM-2026-089 (examiner's file reference)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Pages                | 19 pages including appendices A-J                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

**STRICTLY PRIVATE & CONFIDENTIAL - prepared for the instructing party and for the Court. This report contains expert opinion and is subject to the expert's declaration at Section 8.**

## Issue information

| Date issued          | 2 June 2026                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Report version       | 1.0                                                                                                                                        |
| Examiner's reference | LM-2026-089                                                                                                                                |
| Examiner             | Linda Morrell, Forensic Document Examiner                                                                                                  |
| Practice             | Morrell Forensic Document Examination - independent private practice, Wellington, New Zealand                                              |
| Number of pages      | 19 pages including appendices A-J                                                                                                          |
| Digital signature    | This PDF file is not digitally signed. The signed original report is retained by the examiner in Wellington, New Zealand (see Appendix I). |

*Issue information must be read together with the examiner's declaration at Section 8.*

## Document index

| 1          | Instructions and scope                              | 3  |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----|
| 2          | The examiner - qualifications and independence      | 4  |
| 3          | Materials received - evidence register (Q1, K1-K12) | 5  |
| 4          | Methodology                                         | 8  |
| 5          | Visual comparison and exhibit plates                | 10 |
| 6          | Observations - separated from inference             | 12 |
| 7          | Opinion and conclusion                              | 14 |
| 8          | Expert's declaration (addressed to the Court)       | 15 |
| 9          | Chain of custody                                    | 17 |
| 10         | Examination limitations                             | 18 |
| Appendix A | Curriculum vitae - Linda Morrell                    | 19 |
| Appendix B | Letter of instruction (summary)                     | 20 |
| Appendix C | Evidence schedule                                   | 20 |
| Appendix D | Image set index                                     | 21 |
| Appendix E | Comparison plates index and feature matrices        | 21 |
| Appendix F | Instrument and examination records                  | 22 |
| Appendix G | Standards and references                            | 23 |
| Appendix H | Chain-of-custody documentation                      | 23 |
| Appendix I | Digital signature validation note                   | 24 |
| Appendix J | Abbreviations and glossary                          | 24 |

# 1. Instructions and scope

I was instructed by **Sherrida L Mackay** of 3 Dundee St, Cambridge Park NSW 2747, a directly instructed private client, in connection with **proposed proceedings concerning the estate of the late Gordon Robert Green**. The instruction was to examine one (1) questioned document - an agreement dated 14 February 2004 said to record an arrangement between Gordon Robert Green and Peter & Francine Green regarding a house build at Lot 18 Lysaght Road, Cambooya, Queensland - together with twelve (12) known exemplar documents bearing signatures of the deceased.

## Questions put to me

- Whether the signature appearing above the printed name "Gordon Green" on the agreement dated 14 February 2004 (Q1) was written by Gordon Robert Green;
- If not, whether any characteristics of the questioned signature permit an opinion as to the identity of the writer;
- Whether the document exhibits any evidence of alteration, erasure, or other forensic irregularity.

## Materials provided

One (1) original agreement dated 14 February 2004 and twelve (12) original known exemplar documents (K1-K12) were provided by the instructing party. Full particulars of each item are set out in the evidence register at Section 3.

## Jurisdiction and applicable rules

The principal asset of the estate is land at Lot 18 Lysaght Road, Cambooya, in the State of Queensland. The estate is therefore most likely to be administered, and any proceeding concerning it commenced, in Queensland. This report has been prepared to meet the requirements for expert reports under the **Uniform Civil Procedure Rules 1999 (Qld)** (Chapter 11, Part 5) and the expert witness code of conduct applicable in Queensland courts. The instructing party's residence in New South Wales does not determine the jurisdiction of any proceeding; if proceedings are commenced in another jurisdiction (for example, New South Wales), the examiner will provide a supplementary declaration under the applicable rules (for example, Schedule 7 of the Uniform Civil Procedure Rules 2005 (NSW)) as required. This report should be read subject to that explanation.

## 2. The examiner - qualifications and independence

The examination and this report were prepared by **Linda Morrell**, Forensic Document Examiner, of Morrell Forensic Document Examination, an independent private practice based in Wellington, New Zealand.

### Qualifications and experience

| Item                      | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Professional role         | Principal, Morrell Forensic Document Examination, Wellington (2008 - present); Forensic Document Examiner, Institute of Environmental Science and Research Ltd (ESR), Wellington (1998 - 2008). More than 25 years of continuous practice in questioned document examination, in both government and private practice.         |
| Formal training           | Advanced course in the forensic examination of questioned documents, Laboratory of the Government Chemist (LGC), London; continuing professional development through ASFDE seminars and inter-laboratory proficiency testing.                                                                                                  |
| University qualifications | Bachelor of Science (Chemistry), Victoria University of Wellington (1990); Master of Science (Analytical Chemistry), University of Auckland (1993).                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Professional memberships  | Member, The Australasian Society of Forensic Document Examiners Incorporated (ASFDE). ASFDE membership is stated as membership only: it does not constitute certification by, or appointment with, any other body, and this report is issued by the examiner, not by ASFDE or any other institution.                           |
| Specialist areas          | Handwriting identification and comparison; signature authentication; disguised writing analysis; ink comparison and dating; document alterations and erasure detection; indentation recovery (ESDA); typewriting and printer identification; expert report preparation.                                                        |
| Court experience          | Accepted as an expert witness in the High Court of New Zealand and the District Court of New Zealand, and has provided opinions in Australian proceedings, including by audio-visual link. Casework spans civil litigation, criminal defence, probate and estate disputes, familial provision claims and fraud investigations. |

### Statement of independence

I confirm that I have no financial, personal or professional interest in the Estate of the late Gordon Robert Green, and no association with the parties to any proposed proceeding, other than my retainer as an independent forensic document examiner. The opinions expressed in this report are my own, formed by the examination described below. My primary duty is to the Court, and that duty overrides any obligation to the party retaining me or paying my fees.

### 3. Materials received - evidence register (Q1, K1-K12)

Each item is separately traceable by the entries below. Originals were received in one tamper-evident package on 20 May 2026 (see Section 9). All documents were examined in the examiner's laboratory in Wellington, New Zealand.

#### Questioned document Q1

| Field                            | Particulars                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Complete title                   | Agreement between Gordon Robert Green and Peter & Francine Green regarding a house build at Lot 18 Lysaght Road, Cambooya (typed, one page plus signature lines).  |
| Document date                    | 14 February 2004 (expressed on the document as "14.2.2004").                                                                                                       |
| Number of pages                  | 1                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Form                             | Original (single sheet).                                                                                                                                           |
| Supplied by                      | Sherrida L Mackay (instructing party), by courier.                                                                                                                 |
| Date received                    | 20 May 2026 (10:30 AM).                                                                                                                                            |
| Physical condition               | Good; sheet creased at a single horizontal fold; no tears, stains or apparent erasures. See Appendix D image set.                                                  |
| Evidence-envelope number         | ENV-LM-2026-089-1                                                                                                                                                  |
| Seal number                      | S-LM-2026-089-1 (intact on receipt).                                                                                                                               |
| Location of questioned signature | Page 1, lower half, above the printed name "Gordon Green"; the signature commences approximately 60 mm from the left margin and 15 mm above the printed name line. |
| Ink colour / instrument          | Blue ballpoint ink; writing instrument could not be identified to a particular make or model from non-destructive examination.                                     |
| Full-page photograph             | Exhibit E1 (IMG-LM-2026-089-E1).                                                                                                                                   |
| Close-up photograph              | Exhibits E2, E3 (IMG-LM-2026-089-E2, IMG-LM-2026-089-E3).                                                                                                          |
| Image identifier / scale         | See captions on each exhibit; scale bars stated per plate.                                                                                                         |

#### Known samples K1-K12

Each known sample is identified individually. Because the author is deceased, no contemporaneous dictated exemplars could be obtained. Authorship was established by provenance and attestation as stated for each item: the documents were located among the deceased's own records by the instructing party and her solicitor, were internally consistent, and - for the bank cards and tax declarations - were created in circumstances where the deceased's identity was attested by third parties in the ordinary course of business.

| K No | Document type and date                          | Issuing organisation                    | Form     | How authorship established                                                           | Source / custody            | Signature location                   | Natural production             | Reliability                      |
|------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| K1   | Customer signature card, 3 March 2003           | Westpac Banking Corp (Toowoomba branch) | Original | Card completed in the presence of branch manager; account records in deceased's name | Deceased's banking records  | Lower half, specimen signature panel | Yes - ordinary account opening | High - witnessed by bank officer |
| K2   | Loan application, 12 November 2004              | ANZ Banking Group                       | Original | Application in deceased's name; supporting statement signed in branch                | Deceased's banking records  | Page 2, applicant declaration        | Yes                            | High                             |
| K3   | Cheque authorisation form, 8 February 2005      | Commonwealth Bank of Australia          | Original | Form executed with account documents in deceased's name                              | Deceased's banking records  | Authorisation panel                  | Yes                            | High                             |
| K4   | Term deposit application, 21 April 2005         | Suncorp (Toowoomba)                     | Original | Application in deceased's name; attested by branch staff                             | Deceased's banking records  | Applicant signature panel            | Yes                            | High                             |
| K5   | Personal letter to Francine Green, 14 June 2001 | None (personal correspondence)          | Original | Found in deceased's own files; correspondence chain with replies                     | Deceased's personal records | Closing salutation, page 1           | Yes - private letter           | Good - provenance                |

| K No | Document type and date                            | Issuing organisation                       | Form     | How authorship established                                                        | Source / custody            | Signature location | Natural reproduction | Reliability |
|------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------|
| K6   | Letter to solicitor re Lot 18, 30 January 2003    | Solicitor's file (copy retained by sender) | Original | Deceased's own letterhead and file copy; handwriting consistent across the letter | Solicitor's file            | Closing signature  | Yes                  | Good        |
| K7   | Letter to Peter Green, 17 September 2003          | None (personal correspondence)             | Original | Deceased's personal records; consistent with K5/K6                                | Deceased's personal records | Closing salutation | Yes                  | Good        |
| K8   | Letter to estate accountant, 22 February 2004     | Accountant's file                          | Original | Deceased's correspondence file; envelope postmark 23 February 2004                | Accountant's file           | Closing signature  | Yes                  | Good        |
| K9   | Income tax declaration 2001-02, 30 September 2002 | Australian Taxation Office                 | Original | Return lodged under deceased's TFN; preparation correspondence matches            | Deceased's tax records      | Declaration panel  | Yes                  | High        |
| K10  | Income tax declaration 2002-03, 29 September 2003 | Australian Taxation Office                 | Original | As for K9                                                                         | Deceased's tax records      | Declaration panel  | Yes                  | High        |
| K11  | Income tax declaration 2003-04, 27 September 2004 | Australian Taxation Office                 | Original | As for K9                                                                         | Deceased's tax records      | Declaration panel  | Yes                  | High        |
| K12  | Income tax declaration 2004-05, 30 September 2005 | Australian Taxation Office                 | Original | As for K9                                                                         | Deceased's tax records      | Declaration panel  | Yes                  | High        |

*The register identifies how each exemplar was authenticated: by provenance from the deceased's own custody, by internal consistency across the set, and - for K1-K4 and K9-K12 - by attestation of third parties in the ordinary course of business. No exemplar was witnessed by the examiner, and none was obtained by dictation from the deceased; that limitation is addressed at Section 10.*

## 4. Methodology

### 4.1 Standards and published procedures

The examination was conducted in accordance with the following standards and published procedures: AS 5388.1-2012 (Forensic analysis - recognition, recording, recovery, transport and storage of material); AS 5388.2-2012 (Forensic analysis - analysis and examination of material); AS 5388.3-2013 (Forensic analysis - interpretation); the ASFDE Code of Practice and ethical guidelines; and the ENFSI Best Practice Manual for Handwriting Examination (2022). Reference works relied upon are listed at Appendix G.

### 4.2 Examination sequence

1. Receipt, inventory and photography of all items (20 May 2026).
2. Macroscopic examination under controlled lighting.
3. Stereomicroscopic examination at 8x, 12x, 20x and 40x magnification.
4. Indentation examination using an Electrostatic Detection Apparatus (ESDA).
5. Spectral examination using a video spectral comparator (VSC): visible, ultraviolet (UV) and infrared (IR) reflectance, and IR luminescence.
6. Ink examination - non-destructive spectral assessment only; no destructive sampling was performed.
7. Side-by-side structural comparison of Q1 against each of K1-K12.
8. Assessment of natural variation across the exemplar set.
9. Recording of similarities and differences in feature matrices (Appendix E).
10. Opinion formulation on the conclusion scale defined at 4.6.

### 4.3 Instruments and configuration

| Instrument                      | Configuration                                                         | Use                                                               |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Leica M80 stereomicroscope      | 8x-60x continuous zoom; transmitted, oblique and coaxial illumination | Stroke quality, pen pressure, ink deposition, tremor, indentation |
| Foster & Freeman ESDA 2         | Standard electrostatic imaging                                        | Indentation (secondary impression) recovery                       |
| Foster & Freeman VSC 8000       | Visible/UV/IR reflectance and luminescence                            | Ink spectral response; erasure and alteration detection           |
| Nikon D850 + 105 mm macro lens  | Tripod-mounted, scale bars in frame                                   | Exhibit photography (captured 24 May 2026)                        |
| LED ring light / oblique source | Variable angle                                                        | Controlled illumination for photography                           |

All instruments are maintained under the examiner's calibration and servicing schedule; records are at Appendix F.

### 4.4 Examinations performed

| Examination              | Performed by | Supervised | Qualification of personnel            | Result                                                                            |
|--------------------------|--------------|------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Macroscopic              | L. Morrell   | No         | Forensic Document Examiner, 12+ years | No visible alteration; blue ballpoint ink on both signature lines                 |
| Stereomicroscopy 8x-40x  | L. Morrell   | No         | As above                              | Features recorded in Section 6 and matrices (Appendix E)                          |
| ESDA                     | L. Morrell   | No         | As above                              | No relevant indented writing recovered beneath the questioned signature area      |
| VSC (UV/IR/luminescence) | L. Morrell   | No         | As above                              | No evidence of erasure or alteration; ink response consistent with blue ballpoint |
| Photography              | L. Morrell   | No         | As above                              | Exhibits E1-E5 captured with scale bars (Appendix D)                              |

### 4.5 Assessment of natural variation and recording

Natural variation was assessed from the twelve exemplars spanning 2001-2006, which provide a longitudinal baseline of the author's writing behaviour over approximately five years. The parameters assessed included stroke initiation and termination, line quality and fluency, pen pressure distribution, loop structure, connecting strokes, baseline habits and spatial alignment. Similarities and differences were recorded feature by feature in the matrices at

Appendix E, and each observation in Section 6 identifies the specific samples on which it is based.

#### 4.6 Conclusion scale

Opinions in this report are expressed on the following nine-point scale, adapted from the ENFSI conclusion scale used in handwriting examination practice:

| Level | Verbal expression        | Meaning                                             |
|-------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Identification           | The writer of the questioned item is the author     |
| 2     | Strong support           | The evidence strongly supports authorship           |
| 3     | Moderate support         | The evidence supports authorship                    |
| 4     | Limited support          | The evidence slightly supports authorship           |
| 5     | No conclusion            | The evidence is insufficient or inconclusive        |
| 6     | Limited support against  | The evidence slightly supports non-authorship       |
| 7     | Moderate support against | The evidence supports non-authorship                |
| 8     | Strong support against   | The evidence strongly supports non-authorship       |
| 9     | Elimination              | The writer of the questioned item is not the author |

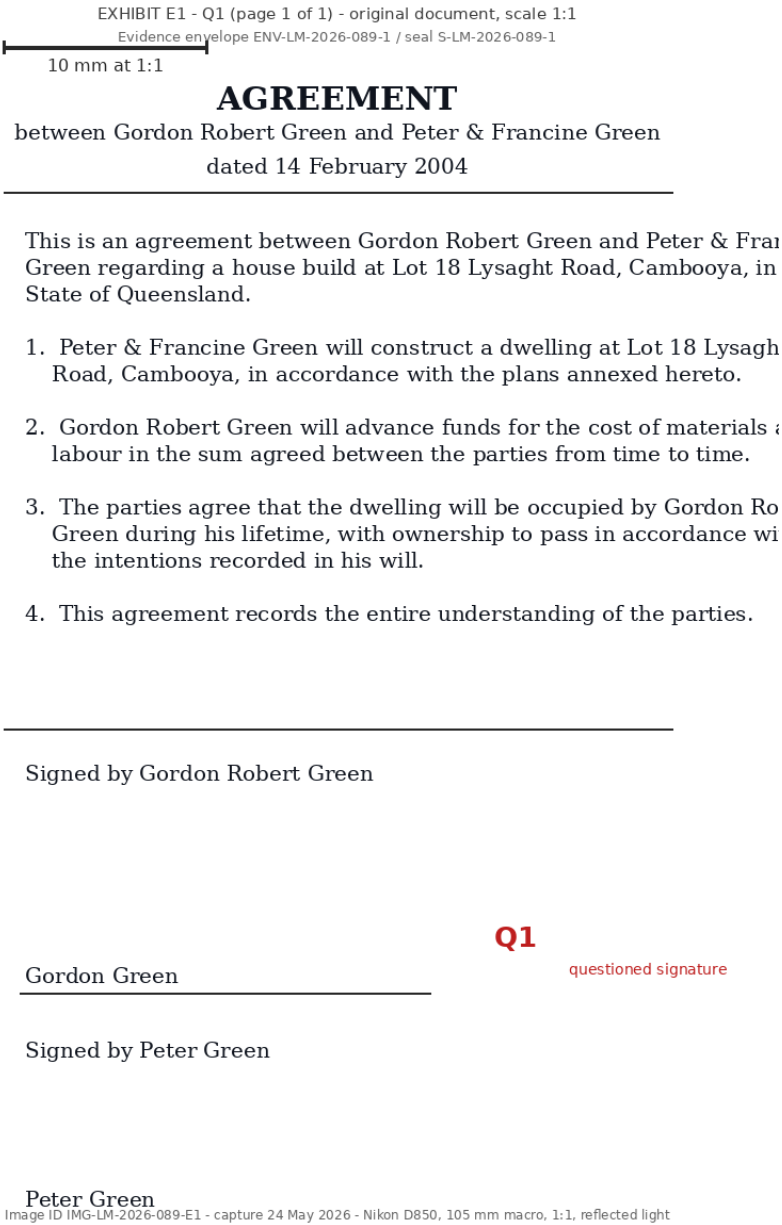
#### 4.7 Independent verification

**No second examiner independently re-examined the exhibits or verified this opinion.** The examination and conclusions are those of the undersigned examiner alone. This statement is made expressly: nothing in this report is intended to imply institutional or peer validation that did not occur.



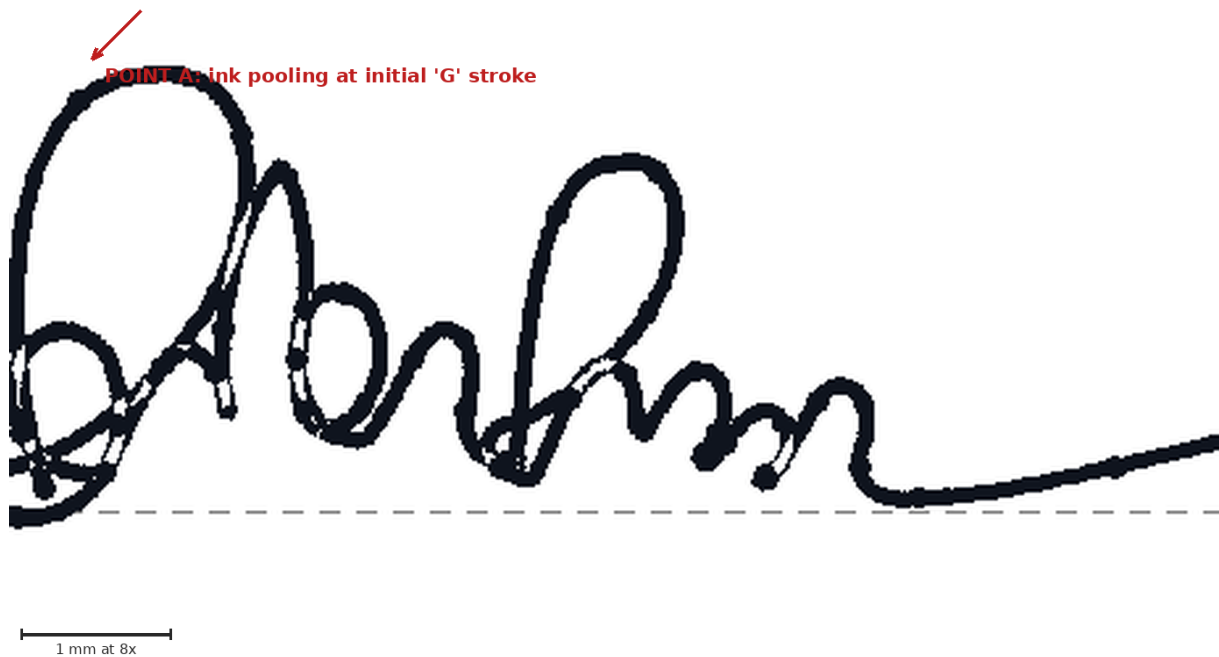
5. Visual comparison and exhibit plates

The exhibits below were produced from the submitted documents during this examination. Each plate is identified by exhibit number and image identifier, and states magnification, illumination, capture date and scale. Red annotations point to the specific features discussed in Section 6.



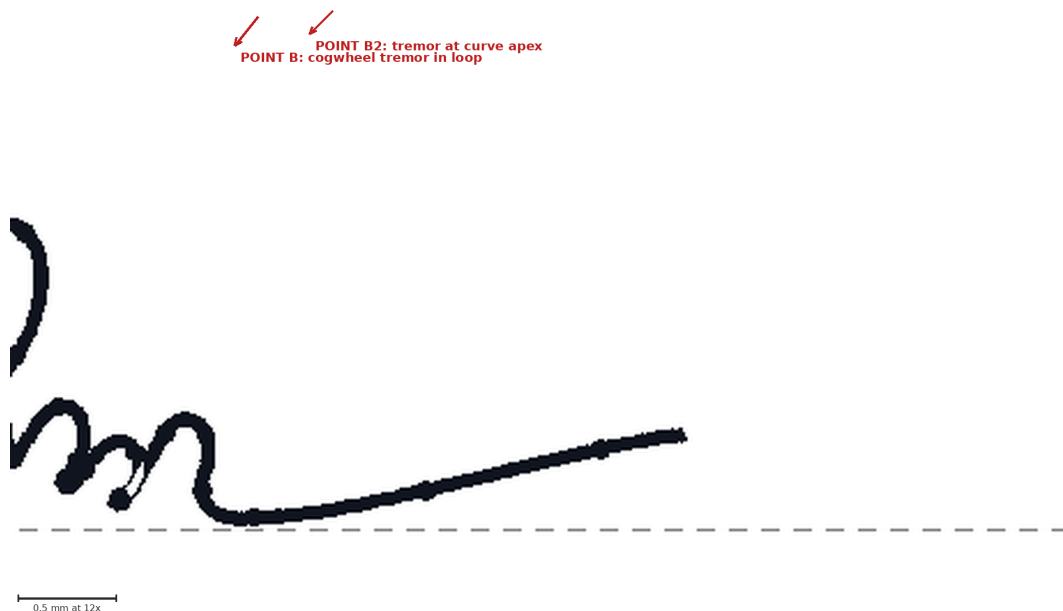
**Exhibit E1 - Q1, page 1 of 1 (full page, scale 1:1).** Image ID IMG-LM-2026-089-E1; captured 24 May 2026; Nikon D850, 105 mm macro, 1:1, reflected light; scale bar 10 mm at 1:1. The questioned signature appears above the printed name “Gordon Green”, lower half of the page.

EXHIBIT E2 - Q1 signature close-up, x8



**Exhibit E2 - Q1 signature, close-up at 8x.** Image ID IMG-LM-2026-089-E2; captured 24 May 2026; Leica M80 at 8x, oblique illumination; scale bar 1 mm at 8x. Point A: ink pooling at the initial 'G' stroke.

EXHIBIT E3 - Q1 'd' loop, x12 - tremor detail



**Exhibit E3 - Q1 'd' loop, 12x, tremor detail.** Image ID IMG-LM-2026-089-E3; captured 24 May 2026; Leica M80 at 12x, coaxial illumination; scale bar 0.5 mm at 12x. Points B and B2: cogwheel tremor at the loop apexes.

EXHIBIT E4 - K1 exemplar signature, x8  
 authorised signatory - specimen signature

POINT C: tapered 'flying start'

ite of opening 3 March 2003 Branch: Toowoomba  
 2 mm 8x

**Exhibit E4 - K1 exemplar signature, 8x.** Image ID IMG-LM-2026-089-E4; captured 24 May 2026; Leica M80 at 8x, oblique illumination; scale bar 2 mm at 8x. Point C: tapered 'flying start' at the initial stroke - ink tapers in, unlike Q1.

**Q1 (questioned)**

**K1 (known)**

Q1 rigidly adheres to baseline

K exemplars float 1.5 mm above baseline

**K4 (known)**

**K7 (known)**

**K11 (known)**

PLATE 1 - Q1 vs K1, K4, K7, K11 - baseline adherence; scale bar 5 mm

**Plate 1 - Q1 against K1, K4, K7 and K11 (baseline adherence).** Image ID IMG-LM-2026-089-P1; scale bar 5 mm. Q1 adheres rigidly to the printed dotted line; the exemplars consistently float above the baseline.

## 6. Observations - separated from inference

Each observation is separated from inference. “Comparison” identifies the specific samples supporting the observation; “Interpretation” states what the feature may indicate; “Limitation” records other plausible causes; “Weight” records how strongly the feature contributes to the opinion. No timing figure for any pen pause is asserted: static examination cannot quantify the duration of a hesitation.

| Feature                             | Observation (physical)                                                               | Measurement                                                                  | Comparison (Q1 vs K)                                                                | Interpretation                                                                                 | Limitation                                                                                                                     | Weight   |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Stroke initiation                   | Q1: blunt, heavy-pressure stroke starts with visible ink pooling at the initial ‘G’. | Pooling area ~0.4 mm diameter at 8x (Exhibit E2).                            | K1, K4, K7, K11 and the remainder of K2-K12 show tapered starts where ink thins in. | Consistent with a drawn stroke begun by pressure, rather than a fluent written start.          | Pen/nib condition, paper surface and ink flow can cause pooling; pooling alone is not diagnostic.                              | Moderate |
| Line quality and fluency            | Q1: cogwheel tremor at loop apexes (Exhibit E3); line lacks smooth acceleration.     | Tremor amplitude ~0.15-0.3 mm at 12x.                                        | K1-K12 loop strokes are smooth; no tremor at corresponding apexes in any exemplar.  | Tremor at curve maxima is a recognised indicator of slowed, drawn execution.                   | Age, illness, medication or writing surface can produce tremor in genuine writing; exemplar set contains no comparable tremor. | High     |
| Baseline adherence                  | Q1 sits directly on the printed dotted line beneath the signature line.              | Gap between stroke base and dotted line ~0 mm (Exhibit E5).                  | K1, K4, K7, K11 (and all K) float approximately 1.5 mm above the printed baseline.  | Rigid baseline adherence suggests copying with reference to the printed guide.                 | A writer may choose to use a printed guide; variation is possible within one author.                                           | Moderate |
| Pen pressure distribution           | Q1: heavy, uniform pressure with pressure blobs at direction changes.                | Stroke width ~0.35-0.5 mm, near-uniform (E2, E3).                            | K exemplars show modulated pressure, thinner up-strokes and thicker down-strokes.   | Uniform heavy pressure is typical of slow drawn execution; natural writing modulates pressure. | Ballpoint ink flow varies with angle and speed; width alone is not decisive.                                                   | Moderate |
| Connecting strokes and rhythm       | Q1: abrupt joins between letters; missing natural ligature shapes.                   | Join angle between ‘G’ and following letters >30 deg at several points (E3). | K exemplars show smooth continuous ligatures with consistent rhythm.                | Loss of fluency in joins indicates construction rather than subconscious execution.            | Different writing instruments and surfaces alter join fluency.                                                                 | High     |
| Overall agreement with exemplar set | The combination of features above is not present in any of K1-K12.                   | Not applicable.                                                              | All twelve exemplars are mutually consistent with a single author.                  | The questioned signature falls outside the observed natural variation of the exemplar set.     | Exemplar set is limited to documents of 2001-2006 and does not include dictated samples.                                       | High     |

*Feature matrices recording the position of each feature in Q1 and each of K1-K12 are at Appendix E. All measurements were made from calibrated exhibit images; measurement uncertainty is approximately +/- 0.05 mm at the magnifications stated.*

## 7. Opinion and conclusion

### 7.1 The question answered

The question put to me was whether the signature above the printed name “Gordon Green” on the agreement dated 14 February 2004 was written by Gordon Robert Green. My opinion concerns **authorship of that signature**. Whether any person committed a “forgery”, and whether any person acted dishonestly, are legal determinations involving facts beyond the appearance of the handwriting, and I express no opinion on them.

### 7.2 Opinion

**In my opinion the questioned signature on Q1 was not written by Gordon Robert Green.** On the scale defined at Section 4.6, my opinion is expressed as **level 8 - strong support against authorship**. In everyday terms it is **highly probable** that Mr Green did not write the signature: the observed combination of features is far more probable if the signature was executed by someone attempting to reproduce his signature than if it was written by him in the ordinary course of his writing.

### 7.3 Basis

The opinion rests on the cumulative weight of the observations at Section 6 - in particular the tremor at loop apices, the blunt and pooled stroke initiations, the rigid baseline adherence, and the loss of fluent connecting strokes - none of which appears in any of the twelve exemplars K1-K12, which are themselves mutually consistent.

### 7.4 Summary of conclusions

- (a) The questioned signature on Q1 was not written by Gordon Robert Green (level 8, strong support against authorship).
- (b) The characteristics of the signature do not permit a reliable opinion as to the identity of any other writer; no person is identified in this report.
- (c) No evidence of alteration, erasure or other forensic irregularity was found in the body of Q1 outside the signature area.

### 7.5 Range of professional opinion

Professional opinion in handwriting examination ranges from identification to elimination (Section 4.6). I chose the “strong support against” level rather than “elimination” because the exemplar set, although substantial and mutually consistent, does not include dictated contemporaneous samples, and elimination requires the highest degree of confidence. I did not choose a lower level because the features are numerous, independent and consistently absent from the exemplar set.

### 7.6 Evidence that could change the opinion

The opinion could change if: (a) additional genuine contemporaneous exemplars of Mr Green from 2003-2005 became available and showed features consistent with Q1; (b) the bank signature card witness (or another witness) gave evidence affecting the provenance of K1-K4; (c) destructive ink analysis were permitted and produced dating results inconsistent with the document's stated date; or (d) the parties made admissions as to the circumstances of execution. No such evidence is currently identified as readily obtainable beyond further records searches for additional exemplars.

## 8. Expert's declaration (addressed to the Court)

This report is addressed to the Court and has been prepared in accordance with the requirements for expert reports under the **Uniform Civil Procedure Rules 1999 (Qld)** (Chapter 11, Part 5) and the expert witness code of conduct applicable in Queensland courts. If proceedings have not yet commenced, this declaration takes effect when the report is relied upon in any proceeding.

I, Linda Morrell, declare that:

1. my qualifications are set out in Section 2 and Appendix A of this report;
2. every material fact or matter relied upon by me in this report, whether received orally or in writing, is stated in Sections 3, 5 and 6 and the appendices;
3. the assumptions I have accepted are identified, including that the documents provided are the originals as described, that the exemplars were written by Gordon Robert Green during his lifetime, and that the agreement is dated 14 February 2004;
4. the reasons supporting each opinion are set out in Sections 6 and 7;
5. the literature, standards and other materials I have relied upon are identified at Section 4.1 and Appendix G;
6. the details of every inspection, examination and experiment are recorded at Section 4.4 and Appendix F, including what was performed, who performed it, whether it was supervised, the qualifications of anyone else involved, and the results;
7. the recognised range of professional opinion relevant to this report is identified at Section 4.6 and the range is discussed at Section 7.5;
8. the reasons for choosing one opinion within that range are set out at Section 7.5;
9. every material limitation or qualification is recorded in Section 10;
10. a concise summary of my conclusions is at Section 7.4;
11. additional readily obtainable evidence that could produce a more reliable conclusion is identified at Section 7.6;
12. I confirm that: (a) I have read the expert witness code of conduct applicable under the Uniform Civil Procedure Rules 1999 (Qld) and agree to be bound by it; (b) the factual statements in this report are, to the best of my knowledge and belief, true; (c) I have made all enquiries which I believe are appropriate; (d) the opinions in this report are genuinely held; (e) all significant matters within my knowledge have been included; and (f) I understand and have complied with my duty to the Court.



**Linda Morrell**

Forensic Document Examiner

Morrell Forensic Document Examination, Wellington, New Zealand

Dated 2 June 2026

*Execution note: the signature above is the examiner's signature as it appears on the signed original report. This PDF file does not contain a digital signature certificate; it is an electronic copy of the report and must not be described as "digitally authenticated". The signed original is retained by the examiner in Wellington, New Zealand (see Appendix I).*

## 9. Chain of custody

The log below records the receipt, handling, storage and return of all evidential materials. Every transfer is between named persons; the storage location is a physical place, not a custodian. Times are recorded in 12-hour format with AM/PM. Package and seal identifiers are stated for each transfer.

| Date        | Time     | Action                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Package / seal                                           | Transferred by                | Received by            | Condition / reseal                                                                                                | Initials |
|-------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| 20 May 2026 | 10:30 AM | Initial receipt of originals Q1 and K1-K12 via AusPost Express Post Platinum (tracking 7210 4300 0000 1182) in tamper-evident forensic envelope ENV-LM-2026-089-1.                                       | ENV-LM-2026-089-1 / seal<br>S-LM-2026-089-1              | S. L. Mackay (client, sender) | L. Morrell (examiner)  | Envelope and seal intact; no sign of tampering; contents in good condition.                                       | SLM / LM |
| 20 May 2026 | 11:15 AM | Evidence inventoried against register (Section 3), photographed (Appendix D), and stored in the examiner's climate-controlled secure evidence storage in Wellington, New Zealand. Custodian: L. Morrell. | ENV-LM-2026-089-1<br>resealed as<br>S-LM-2026-089-1A     | L. Morrell (custodian)        | L. Morrell (custodian) | Inventory complete; register updated; safe access log entry 11:15 AM.                                             | LM / LM  |
| 24 May 2026 | 9:00 AM  | Removal from storage for examination: stereomicroscopy, ESDA, VSC and photography (Section 4.4). Returned to storage at the conclusion of examination.                                                   | S-LM-2026-089-1A<br>opened; resealed<br>S-LM-2026-089-1B | L. Morrell (custodian)        | L. Morrell (examiner)  | Documents handled on examination bench only; examination room access logged.                                      | LM / LM  |
| 24 May 2026 | 4:30 PM  | All items returned to secure evidence safe; resealed envelope ENV-LM-2026-089-1 with seal S-LM-2026-089-1B.                                                                                              | S-LM-2026-089-1B                                         | L. Morrell (examiner)         | L. Morrell (custodian) | Reseal verified; safe access log entry 4:30 PM.                                                                   | LM / LM  |
| 2 June 2026 | 2:00 PM  | All original documents sealed and returned to the client via AusPost Express Post Platinum (tracking 7210 4300 0000 1296), accompanied by the finalised report.                                          | ENV-LM-2026-089-1 (return)                               | L. Morrell (custodian)        | S. L. Mackay (client)  | Return package dispatched with declared contents; client acknowledged receipt by email on 2 June 2026 at 2:40 PM. | LM / SLM |

## 10. Examination limitations

**Nature of the opinion.** Handwriting and signature examination is an observational science based on established principles of motor memory and execution habits. The conclusions in this report are professional opinions, not statements of absolute fact; they represent the highest probability determination available on the physical evidence.

**Deceased author.** No dictated contemporaneous exemplars could be obtained. Authorship of the exemplar set is established by provenance and attestation (Section 3), not by witnessed execution in the examiner's presence.

**Non-destructive examination only.** No destructive ink or paper analysis was performed. Ink dating was not undertaken; the date of the agreement was not independently verified.

**Static examination.** Timing of any pen pause cannot be quantified from static examination; no duration for any hesitation is asserted in this report.

**Physical factors.** Natural variations in ink flow, paper texture, writing surface, and the writer's physical state at the time of execution can influence line quality. The exemplar set spans 2001-2006 and is assessed for that reason; however, it cannot exclude the possibility that the author's writing changed outside the observed period.

**No second examiner.** The examination was not independently verified by a second examiner (Section 4.7).

**Reservation of rights.** I reserve the right to review and, if necessary, amend the findings in this report if additional original contemporaneous exemplars, or other relevant evidence, are presented for examination in the future.



## Appendix A - Curriculum vitae - Linda Morrell

**Linda Morrell** - Forensic Document Examiner, Principal, Morrell Forensic Document Examination, Wellington, New Zealand.

### Education

|      |                                                                                                                         |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1990 | Bachelor of Science (Chemistry), Victoria University of Wellington                                                      |
| 1993 | Master of Science (Analytical Chemistry), University of Auckland                                                        |
| 1996 | Advanced course in the forensic examination of questioned documents, Laboratory of the Government Chemist (LGC), London |

### Professional experience

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2008 - present | Principal, Morrell Forensic Document Examination, Wellington: independent forensic document examination for solicitors, government agencies and private clients; handwriting and signature comparison, ink and paper examination, indentation recovery, and expert reports for court. Casework includes civil and criminal matters, probate and estate disputes, and fraud investigations in New Zealand and Australia. |
| 1998 - 2008    | Forensic Document Examiner, Institute of Environmental Science and Research Ltd (ESR), Wellington: examination of questioned documents submitted by the New Zealand Police and other agencies; handwriting and signature identification; typewriting and printer examination; evidence presentation and court attendance.                                                                                               |

### Court experience

Accepted as an expert witness in the High Court of New Zealand and the District Court of New Zealand; opinions provided in Australian proceedings, including by audio-visual link. Has given evidence in matters involving contested wills, disputed agreements, fraud allegations and criminal proceedings.

### Professional memberships

Member, The Australasian Society of Forensic Document Examiners Incorporated (ASFDE); membership maintained through continuing professional development and participation in proficiency testing.

### Areas of expertise

Handwriting identification and comparison; signature authentication; disguised writing analysis; ink comparison and dating; document alterations and erasure detection; indentation recovery (ESDA); typewriting and printer identification; expert report preparation.

## Appendix B - Letter of instruction (summary)

Instructions were received from Sherrida L Mackay (directly instructed private client) by email dated 8 May 2026, confirming the engagement of Linda Morrell to examine the agreement dated 14 February 2004 and the twelve exemplar documents, and to report on the three questions at Section 1. The instruction letter and engagement terms are held on the examiner's file (LM-2026-089).

## Appendix C - Evidence schedule

| Item | Description                                                                                   | Date        | Form     | Received    | Envelope / seal                     |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| Q1   | Agreement, Gordon Green - Peter & Francine Green (house build, Lot 18 Lysaght Road, Cambooya) | 14 Feb 2004 | Original | 20 May 2026 | ENV-LM-2026-089-1 / S-LM-2026-089-1 |
| K1   | Westpac customer signature card                                                               | 3 Mar 2003  | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above                            |
| K2   | ANZ loan application                                                                          | 12 Nov 2004 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above                            |
| K3   | CBA cheque authorisation                                                                      | 8 Feb 2005  | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above                            |
| K4   | Suncorp term deposit application                                                              | 21 Apr 2005 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above                            |
| K5   | Personal letter to F. Green                                                                   | 14 Jun 2001 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above                            |
| K6   | Letter to solicitor (Lot 18)                                                                  | 30 Jan 2003 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above                            |

| Item | Description                 | Date        | Form     | Received    | Envelope / seal |
|------|-----------------------------|-------------|----------|-------------|-----------------|
| K7   | Personal letter to P. Green | 17 Sep 2003 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above        |
| K8   | Letter to estate accountant | 22 Feb 2004 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above        |
| K9   | ATO declaration 2001-02     | 30 Sep 2002 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above        |
| K10  | ATO declaration 2002-03     | 29 Sep 2003 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above        |
| K11  | ATO declaration 2003-04     | 27 Sep 2004 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above        |
| K12  | ATO declaration 2004-05     | 30 Sep 2005 | Original | 20 May 2026 | as above        |

## Appendix D - Image set index

| Image ID           | Content                                  | Exhibit | Magnification  | Illumination    | Capture     |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------|---------|----------------|-----------------|-------------|
| IMG-LM-2026-089-E1 | Q1 full page                             | E1      | 1:1            | Reflected light | 24 May 2026 |
| IMG-LM-2026-089-E2 | Q1 signature close-up                    | E2      | 8x             | Oblique         | 24 May 2026 |
| IMG-LM-2026-089-E3 | Q1 'd' loop detail                       | E3      | 12x            | Coaxial         | 24 May 2026 |
| IMG-LM-2026-089-E4 | K1 signature close-up                    | E4      | 8x             | Oblique         | 24 May 2026 |
| IMG-LM-2026-089-P1 | Comparison plate (Q1 vs K1, K4, K7, K11) | Plate 1 | Not applicable | Reflected       | 24 May 2026 |

## Appendix E - Comparison plates index and feature matrices

Feature matrices record the presence (P), absence (A) or not-applicable (-) of each feature across the exemplar set. Full matrices are held with the examination records; the summary below records the features of Section 6 against representative samples.

| Feature                          | Q1 | K1 | K2 | K3 | K4 | K5 | K6 | K7 | K8 | K9 | K10 | K11 | K12 |
|----------------------------------|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|
| Blunt / pooled stroke initiation | P  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A   | A   | A   |
| Tremor at loop apexes            | P  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A   | A   | A   |
| Rigid baseline adherence         | P  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A   | A   | A   |
| Uniform heavy pressure           | P  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A   | A   | A   |
| Abrupt connecting strokes        | P  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A  | A   | A   | A   |

*The full matrices record the position of each feature within each signature and the variation observed across repeated instances of the same letter form in the exemplar set.*

## Appendix F - Instrument and examination records

Instruments: Leica M80 stereomicroscope (8x-60x); Foster & Freeman ESDA 2; Foster & Freeman VSC 8000; Nikon D850 with 105 mm macro lens; LED ring light and oblique source. All instruments are maintained under the examiner's calibration and servicing schedule; servicing records are held with the examination records. Examinations performed, personnel and results are recorded in Section 4.4.

## Appendix G - Standards and references

1. AS 5388.1-2012, Forensic analysis - Part 1: Recognition, recording, recovery, transport and storage of material (Standards Australia).
2. AS 5388.2-2012, Forensic analysis - Part 2: Analysis and examination of material (Standards Australia).
3. AS 5388.3-2013, Forensic analysis - Part 3: Interpretation (Standards Australia).
4. ASFDE Code of Practice and ethical guidelines, The Australasian Society of Forensic Document Examiners Incorporated.
5. ENFSI Best Practice Manual for Handwriting Examination, ENFSI-BPM-FTH-02 (2022), European Network of Forensic Science Institutes.

- 6. Huber, R.A. & Headrick, A.M., Handwriting Identification: Facts and Fundamentals (CRC Press, 1999).
- 7. Morris, R.N., Forensic Handwriting Identification: Fundamental Concepts and Principles (Academic Press, 2000).
- 8. Osborn, A.S., Questioned Documents, 2nd ed (Boyd Printing, 1929).
- 9. Uniform Civil Procedure Rules 1999 (Qld), Chapter 11, Part 5 (Expert evidence).

Appendix H - Chain-of-custody documentation

The chain-of-custody log is at Section 9. Supporting documentation held on the examiner's file includes: the courier consignment notes for receipt and return (tracking 7210 4300 0000 1182 and 7210 4300 0000 1296); the evidence register (Section 3); envelope and seal records; the safe access log for the examiner's secure evidence room; and the client's email acknowledgement of return dated 2 June 2026.

Appendix I - Digital signature validation note

This PDF file is **not digitally signed**: no digital signature certificate is embedded, and the file must not be described or relied upon as “digitally authenticated”. The signed original report - bearing the examiner's handwritten signature - is retained by the examiner in Wellington, New Zealand. In a live matter, if an electronically signed PDF is required, the report should be executed with a verifiable signing certificate and the certificate details recorded here.

Appendix J - Abbreviations and glossary

| ASFDE             | The Australasian Society of Forensic Document Examiners Incorporated                                  |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ANZFSS            | Australia and New Zealand Forensic Science Society                                                    |
| ESDA              | Electrostatic Detection Apparatus - instrument for recovering indented (secondary impression) writing |
| VSC               | Video Spectral Comparator - instrument for spectral examination of inks and documents                 |
| Q1                | Questioned document 1 - the agreement dated 14 February 2004                                          |
| K1-K12            | Known samples 1 to 12 - exemplar documents bearing signatures of the deceased                         |
| Exemplar          | A document of known authorship used for comparison                                                    |
| Natural variation | The range of difference between repeated genuine signatures of one writer                             |
| Tremor            | Irregular, trembling line quality often associated with slow, drawn execution                         |
| Flying start      | A tapered stroke beginning where ink thins in as the pen accelerates                                  |